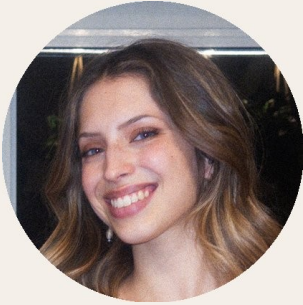




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[linkedin.com/in/violapica](https://www.linkedin.com/in/violapica)

[violapica.github.io](https://github.com/violapica)

London, UK

SKILLS

Design Software

- Rhino 3D, AutoCAD, SketchUp
- Adobe Suite (InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, Lightroom)
- Revit (self-taught)

Technical

- 3D rendering & model making
- Orthographic & MEP technical drawings
- Architectural detailing, joinery

Soft Skills

- Client management & presentations
- Project coordination
- Planning & building regulations

LANGUAGES

Italian - native

English - native

Spanish - fluent

VIOLA PICA

Interior and Architectural Designer

MA Interior Design candidate at the Royal College of Art, with a RIBA Part 1-certified background in adaptive reuse and material-led design. Two years at East JR in Bethnal Green delivering hospitality, retail, and residential projects from early concept through to construction documentation. RIBA First Prize winner and Dezeen-published, with an active role in the RIBA SELA Architects Network and a particular interest in AI-integrated design workflows.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Design and Studio Assistant

East JR, London · May 2024 - Mar 2026

- Supported concept development and client presentations from early-stage proposals
- Produced MEP and joinery technical drawings
- Built 3D models for bespoke joinery and interior packages
- Coordinated materials, suppliers, and project documentation
- Led signage/branding design and project photography, content, and website updates

Architectural Designer, Freelance

Sulla Strada ONLUS · Guatemala & Italy · 2023 - 2025

- Produced technical drawings and visualizations for a 250 sqm facility in Cerro La Granadilla, Guatemala - secured project funding
- Collaborated with engineers to ensure feasibility and alignment with local construction methods
- Integrated permaculture and agroecological principles into sustainable, cost-effective design
- Now designing Instituto Tecnológico, a €1M+ funded vocational training centre

RIBA Future Architecture Mentoring Scheme

APE Architects · Jun - Aug 2022

- Site visits and project analysis for hands-on architectural workflow exposure

Mountain Refuge Staff Member

Monte Velino, Abruzzo · Jul - Aug 2023

- Managed accommodation and facility operations at 2,102m ASL; guided sustainability education for guests

INTERESTS

- Hand drawing / painting
- Photography & videography
- Rock climbing, acrobatic gymnastics
- Glassblowing
- Neuropsychology

REFERENCES

Edwin Ryder

Founder & Creative Director,
East JR
edwin@eastjr.co.uk

Steve Jensen

Masters Course Lead, RCA
steve.jensen@rca.ac.uk

EDUCATION

Royal College of Art

MA Interior Design · 2025 - 2026

Thesis proposes adaptive reuse of a redundant Canary Wharf corporate tower into space for artists, makers and the public, through salvaged and repurposed materials.

Ravensbourne University London

BA (Hons) Interior Design & Environmental Architecture · 2020 - 2023

Specialised in refurbishments, renovations, sustainability, and interior solutions. Developed skills in 3D modelling, technical drawing, and environmental architecture. RIBA Part 1 certified.

AWARDS & INDUSTRY ENGAGEMENT

- Image/Drawing Prize Nominee - The Unlikely Tenant, MA Thesis, RCA (2026)
- RIBA First Prize - Best Final Major Project, BA (2023)
- Published on Dezeen (2023)
- RIBA SELA End-of-Year Show Judge (2024)
- Active member, RIBA SELA Architects Network (2024-present)
- Shortlisted, Craft Excellence Awards - IE Summer Show (2023)